

**The *AI-native* seed fund for Israeli  
founders turning Cyber & Infra Into  
*AI-delivered Outcomes.***

WHO WE ARE

# Cloud-era pioneers. Outcome-era investors.

A team of proven operators and venture capitalists with a track record of scaling businesses and driving successful investments



**Gil Zimmermann**  
STRATEGY & LEADERSHIP

Driving Lama’s strategy and capital formation, with firsthand experience building enterprise companies from inception to exit.

**Track Record:** \$1B+ exit value  
· Former CEO · CloudLock (\$300M+ acq. by Cisco) · Zoomin · 8200 / Mamram



**Ron Zalkind**  
PRODUCT & BUYER INSIGHT

Bringing the enterprise buyer’s lens, translating operational pain into trusted products and enterprise-ready adoption.

**Track Record:** Former CTO / CISO · CloudLock (\$300M+ acq. by Cisco) · Led teams of 1,000+ ppl · IAF / Mamram



**Tsahy Shapsa**  
US ENTERPRISE GTM & SALES

Bringing U.S. enterprise GTM depth to turn technical insight into buyer urgency, repeatable sales motion and scalable growth.

**Track Record:** \$500M+ ARR scaled · 15 years U.S. GTM · CloudLock (\$300M+ acq. by Cisco) · IDF Negotiation Team



**Roy Katzenelson**  
TALENT & VENTURE EXECUTION

Driving founder sourcing and deal formation, identifying high-agency talent and turning early trust into fundable companies.

**Track Record:** 7 years VC at aMoon & lool · \$100M+ deployed · Founding investor in Atero (\$150M acq. by Crusoe)



**Sharon Seemann**  
VC BRAND & PORTFOLIO MARKETING

Driving brand, platform and portfolio marketing strategy, helping Lama and its portfolio build credibility with strategic audiences.

**Track Record:** 9 years VC · Former Partner & CMO at YL Ventures · Litigator & Supreme Court clerk · 8200



**Michal Krymolowski Junio**  
OPERATIONAL EXCELLENCE

Driving fund operations, execution discipline, and the operating infrastructure behind repeatable performance.

**Track Record:** Managing Director at W2W / 8200 alumni org · Former Chief of Staff at ShipIn Systems

\$1B+

Cumulative exits

\$500M+

ARR scaled

\$100M+

Capital deployed

20+ yrs

Working together

CEO · CISO · CTO · GTM · VC · Operations

All in the GP



AI is a Business Extinction level event.  
Evolve or Die

# THE WALKING DEAD





# The Lama Thesis in a nutshell.

## 01 • THE MARKET SHIFT

**Enterprise is buying outcomes, not tools.**

Buyers no longer want dashboards or features. They want measurable work that gets done.

## 02 • THE OPPORTUNITY

**Cyber & infra are full of expert-heavy workflows.**

Pen testing, IR, remediation, DLP, compliance – all expensive, all ready for agentic labor.

## 03 • THE LAMA EDGE

**Operator, buyer, GTM, VC at one table.**

20+ years building, buying, selling and scaling enterprise security from Israel into the US.

## 04 • THE PROOF

**Fund I already maps to the thesis.**

100% of active companies on the Outcomes Playbook, top-quartile early returns, validated by tier-1 follow-on investors.

# The next cyber & infra companies will sell **outcomes**, not tools.

The AI era is changing how enterprise customers work, what they need, and what they are willing to buy. Forcing a rethink of how the next startups are built.

## THE BUYER IS CHANGING

*CISO* → **CISO + CIO + CTO + CAITO**

A new buyer category is forming before VC networks and procurement playbooks harden.

## THE PRODUCT IS CHANGING

*Tools* → **Outcome Delivery**

Software is shifting from supporting work to performing it, combining agents and human expertise around delivered outcomes.

## THE FOUNDER IS CHANGING

*Credentialed* → **High-agency Builder**

Winners deliver results, not features. The work gets done – or it doesn't.

This is **the Outcomes Playbook**. Lama is defining it before the market names it.

# The market is already repricing outcomes.

As AI infrastructure becomes more accessible, value is moving up the stack toward workflow ownership, proprietary domain data, enterprise integration, and measurable outcomes.

## SIGNAL 01 • BUYER URGENCY

**Pilots are everywhere; production is the bottleneck.**

Bain 2025: 74% of companies rank AI as a top-three priority, and 80% of agentic use cases meet or exceed expectations, yet **only 23% can tie AI to revenue or cost savings.**

## SIGNAL 02 • BUDGET SHIFT

**The budget unit is changing.**

As AI moves from assistant to operator, budgets are shifting from seats to completed work and measurable outcomes.

**Examples:** Salesforce Agentforce, HubSpot Breeze, Intercom Fin

## SIGNAL 03 • CATEGORY SHIFT

**Services are becoming software subscriptions.**

Cyber & Infra operations are next: urgent, expert-heavy workflows where buyers need outcomes delivered.

**Examples:** Abridge, Harvey, Sierra, EvenUp.

## SIGNAL 04 • VC SHIFT

**Follow-on capital is forming around outcomes.**

The market is funding companies that sell completed work, not tools.

**Examples:** Decagon \$1.5B, Sierra \$10B, Abridge \$5.3B; Torq \$1.2B; 7AI \$700M.

The window is open **now**. The fund that defines the **Outcomes Playbook** captures the cohort.

# The Israeli cyber playbook is narrowing. The Outcomes Playbook is forming.

| FACTOR             | ESTABLISHED CYBER PLAYBOOK             | OUTCOMES PLAYBOOK                            | WHY IT MATTERS                                                 |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Buyer              | CISO-led                               | Multimodal: CISO + CIO + CTO + CAITO         | Expanding buyer base                                           |
| Product            | Tool / workflow                        | Outcome delivered                            | Value tied to measurable work.                                 |
| Revenue\Traction   | Product ARR, 9-12 months to first deal | Service-start → software subscription        | Revenue can start before product maturity.                     |
| Founder            | Credentials first                      | High agency first                            | High agency matters most in undefined markets                  |
| Investor edge      | Network access                         | Operator-founder fit + buyer design partners | investor edge moves from access to hands-on operating judgment |
| Investor Value Add | Capital, Network, Advice               | Agentic VC Harness                           | VC at the speed of AI, with agentic value delivery that scales |

We don't need the shift to be complete. We need to be best positioned for where the weight is moving.

# The talent engine that built Israeli cyber is now turning toward AI-native outcomes.

Israel became a global cyber powerhouse because its talent model is different: early selection into elite technical and intelligence units, real operational exposure young, and constant pressure to solve mission-critical problems with limited resources. The same engine is now turning toward AI.

**\$8.27 B** ▲ ~110% YoY Israeli cyber funding, 2025 — record year, on top of \$3.8B in 2024.

**\$72.6 B** Israeli cyber exit value, 2025.

**~40 %** of U.S. private cyber funding, 2024.

## 01

THE MODEL

### Cyber proved the model.

Select exceptional technical talent early, train it under pressure, expose it to real adversarial problems , and release it into a dense startup ecosystem.

## 02

THE NEXT GROUND

### AI is the new battle ground.

Israel's MoD AI & Autonomy Administration is now connecting defense R&D, IDF tech units, academia, industry and startups around AI and autonomous systems.

## 03

THE DEFAULT

### High Agency is the default.

Israeli founders are shaped by constraint: geopolitical pressure , limited resources, a small local market, and the need to sell globally from day one.

## 04

THE BRIDGE

### Lama connects talent to U.S. demand.

Dual gravity by design: Tel Aviv for talent and company formation; Boston and the U.S. for enterprise buyers, GTM, and follow-on capital.

Israel produced the founders for the cyber era. The next wave will be Israeli founders turning AI into measurable enterprise outcomes.



# Why Lama wins **this category.**

The next cyber & infra outcome companies need backers who have built, sold, bought, financed, and positioned enterprise security companies before the playbook existed.

## 01 · PATTERN RECOGNITION

### Built the last platform shift.

We have built through market shifts before. In cloud security, we pioneered categories before buyers, budgets, and playbooks were clear. Today, we apply that pattern recognition to the outcomes era.

## 02 · BUYER FROM INSIDE

### Understand the buyer from the inside.

CTO/CISO and deep cyber & IT operating experience embedded in the GP. We have been the buyer, managed the teams, owned the risk, and know how enterprise pain becomes budget.

## 03 · ISRAEL → US BRIDGE

### Know How Israeli Companies Win in the U.S.

Enterprise fluency from Sun, EMC, NetApp, and Cisco, combined with 15 years in U.S. GTM and \$500M+ ARR scaling experience, turns Israeli technical depth into buyer urgency and repeatable enterprise sales.

## 04 · INSTITUTIONALIZATION

### Bring Venture Execution

\$100M+ deployed, category-defining cyber platform experience, and global VC/LP access to support follow-on capital. Turning early conviction into institutional-quality companies.

## SELECTED PRIOR OUTCOMES

**CloudLock** \$300M+ to Cisco

**Zoomin** \$500+ to Salesforce

**Atero** \$150M to Crusoe

**Koi** \$400M to PANW

**Polyrize** to Varonis

**Empow** to Cybereason

**Capsule8** to Sophos

**Okera** to Databricks

# The dealflow engine compounds.

Four pillars generate proprietary, off-market deal flow, often before a company exists. Each one feeds the next, so the pipeline strengthens with every cycle.

01

EMBEDDED TALENT

We grow the next founders inside our portfolio.

Senior operators we recruit into portcos become the next generation of founders we back.

Shahar Peled — VP GTM at Jit → Founder & CEO of Terra.

02

FOUNDER & ANGEL NETWORK

A referral engine tuned for high-agency talent.

Driving value for founders & co-investors so the best teams reach us first, creating a closed-loop trust network.

Raviv Rachmiel — Referred by an angel → Founder & CEO of Iris.

03

PROACTIVE SOURCING AGENTS

Agents that scan for signal before the market sees it.

We map the leading indicators of company formation, vesting cliffs, founder graphs etc., and let agents surface them proactively.

The VC Harness, pointed at sourcing.

04

GRASSROOTS BRAND

Category authority that pulls founders to us.

Events, thought leadership, and platform turn Lama into the brand founders associate with the Outcomes Playbook.

Thought leadership → inbound founder trust.

THE NETWORK

Operators & angels whose access feeds our pipeline

Oz Golan · NoName (Akamai)

Amit Assaraf · Koi (PANW)

Asaf Ezra · A16Z (Granulate)

Michael Dolinsky · Ermetic (Tenable)

Udi Mokady · CyberArk

Zohar Alon · Dome9, NewCore

Ronnie Zehavi · Cerca

Vladi Sandler · Lightspin (Cisco)

# Fund I was already proving the Outcomes Playbook.

The current portfolio already maps to the thesis.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>REPLACES · PEN-TEST CONSULTANTS</p> <p><b>Terra</b></p> <p>Agentic penetration testing platform</p> <p>AI-native continuous pentesting that delivers measurable security outcomes, not consultant hours.</p> | <p>REPLACES · IR RETAINERS</p> <p><b>Agentic IR</b></p> <p>AI-native incident response</p> <p>Autonomous incident response that compresses the consulting motion into software. Service-start model</p> | <p>REPLACES · MANUAL PATCHING</p> <p><b>Root</b></p> <p>Autonomous supply-chain remediation</p> <p>Replace dev/sec engineers, patching CVEs at scale.</p>                   |
| <p>REPLACES · APPSEC ENGINEERING</p> <p><b>Jit</b></p> <p>DevSecOps automation</p> <p>AppSec engineers. pioneering labor-replacement before the term was crisp.</p>                                             | <p>ENABLES · SAFE AGENT ADOPTION</p> <p><b>Capsule</b></p> <p>Runtime security for AI agents</p> <p>The guardrails enterprises need to put agents into production.</p>                                  | <p>ENABLES · SAFE DATA USE IN THE AI ERA</p> <p><b>Orion</b></p> <p>AI-native data loss prevention</p> <p>DLP rebuilt for an era where data flows through AI workflows.</p> |

4 of 6 active investments are direct labor-acceleration plays. 2 enable agentic transformation at enterprise scale. 100% on thesis.

# Three compounding layers, built in the window **before the category settles.**

## LAYER 01 - Market Dialogue & Buyer Insights **01**

### AI Transformation Council

A 30-50 person buyer-side network of CIOs, CISOs, CTOs, and CAITOs actively running agentic transformation programs.

Quarterly working sessions on outcome-based procurement and agentic ROI.

Peer benchmarks for members; qualified design partners for portfolio.

**Demand-side analog to VCs CISO network – for a buyer not yet settled.**

## LAYER 02 - Market Friction **02**

### Category-Mapping Thought Leadership.

Quarterly public publication of the agentic-labor map for cyber & infra

Which service lines are ripe; what the labor-arbitrage math looks like.

What buyer signals matter; what founder profile attacks each category.

**Compounds category authority, founder trust, platform leverage and higher-quality company formation.**

## LAYER 03 - Agentic Fund Value **03**

### The Agentic VC Harness

We use the labor-replacement playbook on ourselves: Lama as live proof-of-thesis.

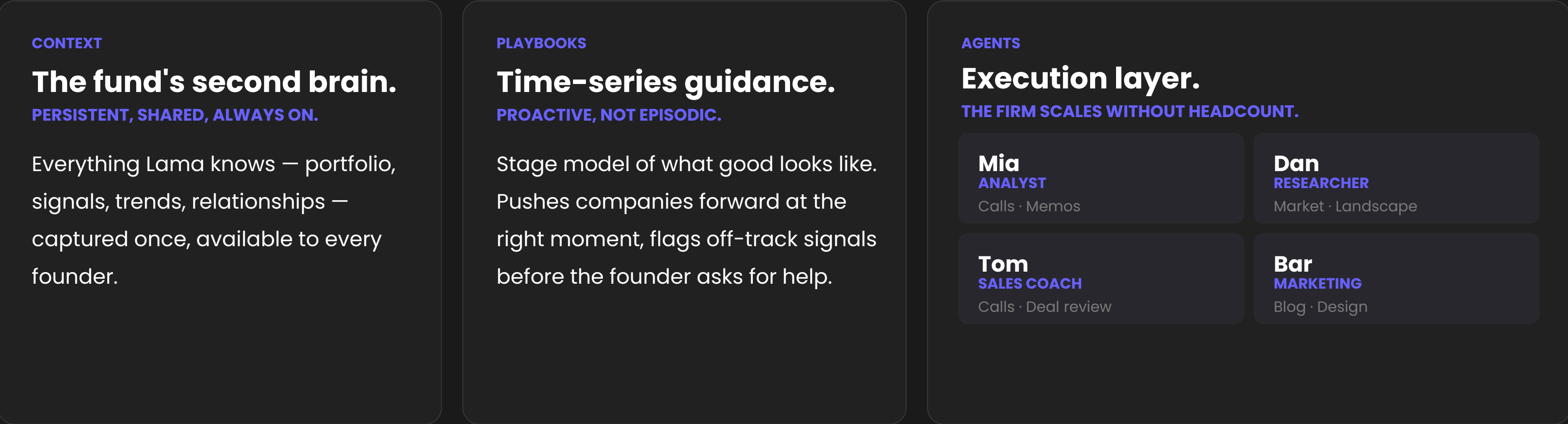
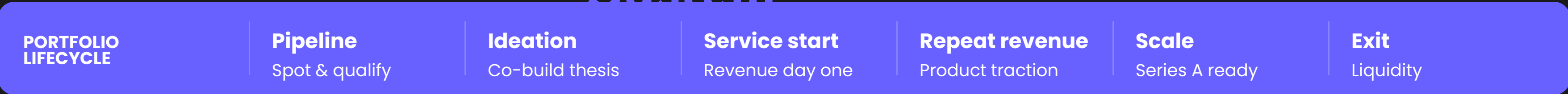
Agent-enabled fund operations turns overlooked fund infrastructure into a repeatable advantage.

**When asked how we operate, the answer is the thesis.**



# The Lama VC Harness

## our agentic Operating System



# Validation is already compounding.

FOUNDER VALIDATION

“The way they supported us throughout ideation and validation helped us focus on the future, rather than the obvious solutions, a decision that has proven itself substantially.”  
**SHAHAR PELED** · FOUNDER & CEO, TERRA

“Working with an operator-led VC has been a game-changer for us as first-time founders. They are partners, not just check writers.”  
**NITAY MILNER** · FOUNDER & CEO, ORION

“The Lama team have been true thought leaders, helping us build a solution that doesn't just protect agentic adoption, it accelerates it.”  
**NAOR PAZ** · FOUNDER & CEO, CAPSULE

“A cornerstone in building Root, from making the team introductions through strategic product and GTM, to tactical workflow work through a substantial shift.”  
**IAN RIOPEL** · FOUNDER & CEO, ROOT

FOLLOW-ON & CO-INVESTORS

|                                                                                       |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|    |    |    |
|    |    |    |
|  |  |  |
|  |  |  |

LP & OPERATOR VALIDATION

|                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <br><b>Jeff Horing</b><br>Founding Partner, Insight    | <br><b>Udi Mokady</b><br>Founder & CEO, CyberArk        |
| <br><b>John McMahon</b><br>Board · Snowflake, MongoDB | <br><b>Amit Agarwal</b><br>GP ICONIQ · ex-CPO, Datadog |
| <br><b>Michael Skok</b><br>GP, Underscore.vc         | <br><b>Bob Goodman</b><br>GP, Bessemer Ventures       |

Tier-1 follow-on and co-investors across the portfolio. **2 Series A term-sheets signed** within 18 months of inception.

Plus Scott Tobin (**Battery**), Erez Ofer (**ex-Greylock / 83North**), Izhar Armony (**CRV**), Yaron Samid (**TechAviv**), Chip Hazard (**Flybridge**), Vinny Smith (**ex-Quest Software**).

# High agency is underwriting discipline, not intuition.

In outcome-native companies, the founder must sell before the category exists, deliver before the product is complete, and productize what works. Credentials help. High agency is required.

## 01 Can they deliver the first outcome manually?

Before software scale: can they make the customer's pain disappear with their own hands?

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## 02 Can they turn delivery into repeatable workflow data?

The moat is not the model. It is accumulated domain workflow intelligence – what the company learns by doing the work.

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## 03 Can they productize without losing urgency?

Service-start is a wedge, not a destination. The discipline to step from delivery into software is the rare skill.

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**We underwrite first-time founders through evidence, not hype: high-agency operators, mapped against a repeatable outcomes playbook.**

# The risks are real. The fund design is built around them.

|                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Differentiation vs. Israeli Cyber funds | <p>OUR ANSWER</p> <p>We aren't competing to be another CISO-network fund. We are building the outcome-native buyer network and procurement playbook for CIO/CISO/CTO/CAITO.</p>            |
| Repeatability of returns                | <p>OUR ANSWER</p> <p>The VC Harness turns sourcing, validation, onboarding, GTM support and Series A prep into a repeatable system, not a series of anecdotes.</p>                         |
| First-time founder risk                 | <p>OUR ANSWER</p> <p>High agency is the filter. Council validation and service-start milestones reduce execution risk before product risk shows up.</p>                                    |
| DPI path / exit liquidity               | <p>OUR ANSWER</p> <p>Cyber + IT outcomes have strategic acquirers, realistic mid-market exit potential, and SPV / co-invest flexibility for outliers.</p>                                  |
| Israel risk                             | <p>OUR ANSWER</p> <p>The same pressure that creates instability produces high-agency operators building from necessity. Lama bridges Israeli technical talent to US enterprise demand.</p> |



# Origin of the **Lama** למה

CloudLock, c. 2014

**A dinosaur that came out wrong.**

THE SKETCH

Our Partner Ron Zalkind tried to draw a dinosaur on a customer call to make a point about customers that refuse to evolve. What came out looked more like a chicken crossed with a llama. That mistake became the mascot.

**Adapt, or be replaced.**

THE MEANING

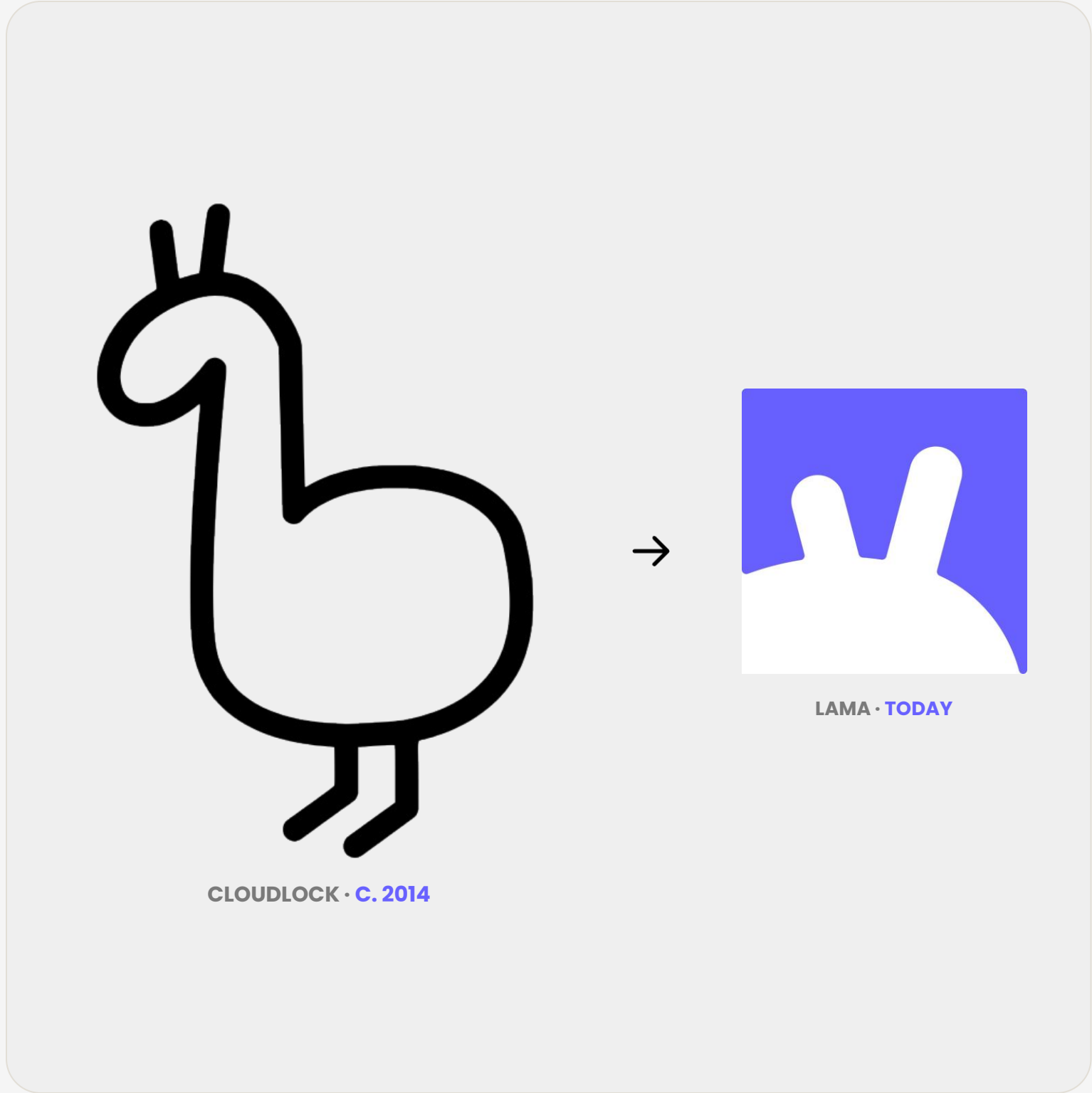
Cling to the past and risk extinction, or adapt and capture what comes next. The same choice every customer we worked with at CloudLock days had to make. The same choice every Israeli cyber fund faces today.

**The investors we always wanted.**

THE FIRM

Operators first. Bold, a little unconventional, always evolving. Working with best-in-class founders building for the US market, helping them avoid the mistakes we made.

**A mistake that became a mascot. A mascot that became a worldview.**



The original ChickenLlama was sketched mid-call – a mistake that became CloudLock's mascot. Twelve years later, those two ears are the brand mark.

LAMA PARTNERS

# Thank you.

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